



Ashraellen

Professional Dossier 2026

Nikolai Kostyshev / Ashraellen

Artistic research · Literary work · Public archive

A concise professional overview for publishers, cultural institutions, grant programmes, research partners and patrons.

Professional overview

Ashraellen is the working name of Nikolai Kostyshev, an independent writer and artistic researcher living in Poland. The project brings together literary prose, phenomenological observation, social satire, digital culture, public philosophical practice, video, sound and a multilingual archive.

Ashraellen is not merely a name, but a mode of seeing. It is a lifelong artistic-philosophical inquiry into meaning, perception, self-deception, inner freedom and the human loss of contact with reality.

Books, essays, novels, videos, sound works, satire, symbolic analysis, public formulas and the multilingual archive are not separate content products, but different forms of recording one long investigation.

Central question

Where does interpretation end, and where does reality begin?

The project observes how a human being replaces direct perception with interpretation; how pain becomes worldview; how fear turns into belief; how language, ideology, religion, digital pressure or personal trauma may begin to think in place of the person.

Professional frames

Artistic research

A practice where novels, essays, video, sound, images and public response work as instruments of observation. Artistic form is treated as a way of investigating experience, not as decoration around a thesis.

Open knowledge

A multilingual public form of philosophical reflection outside closed academic or institutional spaces. The project creates accessible points of entry without simplifying the density of the work.

Digital society

An observation of how digital speed, information noise, algorithmic pressure and fragmented attention affect meaning, identity, inner ground and contact with reality.

Independent digital archive

A structured public archive preserving texts, books, observations, fragments and research directions outside the disappearing flow of social media platforms.

Method of observation

The method is observation and the recording of knots of meaning. It does not begin with a thesis to prove or a system to build, but with the moment when a knot of meaning appears inside an experience, a phrase, a reaction, a scene, a fear, a pain or a coincidence.

The novel works as a long optical instrument. Essays and formulas record moments of clarity. Video and social platforms test thought in live public response. Images address pre-conceptual structures of perception.

The universality of observation is tested not only by statistics, but by recognition: the moment when the reader encounters a description of their own experience where they did not expect to find it.

Selected works and directions

MONOLITH A trilogy of social fiction, dystopia and philosophical cyberpunk about control, memory, systems and the transformation of the human being into the material of surrounding structures. Volumes: BETON, SLUDGE, GAS.	BETON The first volume of MONOLITH: a philosophical dystopia about a world where stability becomes a prison and memory becomes editable material.
SLUDGE The second volume of MONOLITH: a book about the loss of form, coercion into complicity and the gradual transformation of a person into the material of the surrounding system.	GAS The third volume of MONOLITH, in development: a continuation of the investigation of control, system language, memory and the collapse of meaning.
Error 404: God Not Found A multilingual cycle of philosophical-satirical novels about the Heavenly Chancellery and people who seek God through distorted forms of their own fear, pain, knowledge, belief, profession or control.	The Book of Whinesis A satirical project about burnout, complaint, self-deception, digital salvation, info-business and the mechanics of immobility.
You Are Already Online A psychological techno-thriller about a person who begins to notice that reality responds not to events, but to the readiness to confirm them.	Formulas and mini-essays Short public forms of observation: one thought, one mechanism, one precise cut of experience. They connect the public field with larger literary forms.

Formula of Error 404: God Not Found

God is not found not because He is absent. God is not found because the human being seeks Him as an object, an address, an authority, a proof, an excuse, a guarantee or a support service. The error is not in God. The error is in the mode of search.

Public platform

Ashraellen develops not as a single media channel, but as a system of public forms. Each form reveals the shared research field in its own register: direct philosophical reflection, satire, symbolic analysis, sound, everyday ritual, literary work or an experimental archive of images.

Ashraellen - Spirit of the New Time The main philosophical-research channel: clarity, observation, discipline of mind, the inner mechanisms of the human being, work with interpretation and perception.	“Church” of Saint Whine A satirical-philosophical project about burnout, whining, self-deception, info-business and digital fatigue.
Occultus Scriptorium A symbolic-cultural direction about hidden meanings of fairy tales, cartoons, films, myths and cultural plots.	Melodies & Sounds of Inner Peace A sound direction connected with inner peace, silence, attention and presence.
Sacred Taste A practical-poetic direction about cooking as a form of meditation, attention, taste, ritual and return to simple actions.	Ordo Sacrunomiconis / Sacrunomicon An experimental symbolic branch working with imaginal forms, visual signs, an invented tradition and archival aesthetics.

Multilingual structure

Ashraellen.com is structured in nine language versions: English, Russian, Belarusian, Polish, Ukrainian, Portuguese, Spanish, French and German. Multilingual adaptation is understood not as mechanical translation, but as careful access to the original core of meaning.

Current stage and need for support

The project is seeking support for twelve months of sustained work. Support is needed not for expansion for its own sake, but for the transition from fragmented work to a stable cycle:

- observation -> text -> publication -> translation -> public response -> archive
- book preparation and editorial systematisation
- video, audio and multilingual publication
- development of the digital archive and public entry points
- stable infrastructure for writing, editing, storage, backup and production

Technical infrastructure

The project has already moved beyond simple text work. It includes video editing, multilingual voiceover, image preparation, processing of large archives, website development, digital publication of books and work with several language versions. Equipment and subscriptions in this context are working means of the project.

Expected outcomes

- strengthened multilingual platform Ashraellen.com
- structured public archive of books, observations, formulas, fragments and sources
- prepared literary projects and electronic publications
- translated and adapted key materials
- new video, audio, subtitles and short formats
- a sustainable working cycle of observation, publication, translation, archiving and public feedback

Audience and public value

The audience receives access to precise, non-simplified forms of observation that help recognise mechanisms of anxiety, self-deception, loss of inner support and rupture with reality - without motivational rhetoric, ideological frames or ready-made recipes.

- short public formulas for quick recognition
- mini-essays for calm reflection
- fragments and major literary works for deep immersion
- video and audio materials for those who perceive thought better through voice and rhythm

Public response

The public work of Ashraellen already generates significant response across platforms. Individual videos have reached tens of thousands of views; one video has exceeded 500,000 views. At the same time, part of the work remains intimate and experimental; the project values both broad reach and precise recognition.

Cooperation

The project is open to publishing cooperation, cultural programmes, residencies, grant support, institutional partnership and private patronage. A detailed budget, work schedule and project plan can be prepared according to the requirements of a specific programme, publisher, residency or institution.

Contacts and links

Website: <https://www.ashraellen.com/>

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